

New Testament Proofreading Checklist: Instructions

Find one or more people on the translation team who care about details in printed words and notice errors. It is best to find proofreaders who notice such things easily and who enjoy this kind of work.

Each proofreader should look at **one chapter at a time**. He or she should use the Proofreading Checklist to focus on **one category at a time**. This will make the work most effective.

When the proofreader finds anything that should be fixed in the chapter, he or she should mark it or write it down.* When a category has been checked throughout the chapter, the proofreader should mark the corresponding Checklist box to show that its category is completely checked. The proofreader should also correct spelling errors in common words, but should talk with the team for decisions on difficult word choices, or if the same word seems to be misspelled many times.

Finding format issues requires a different kind of “looking” than when someone reads through for meaning. This process will get faster once each proofreader gains experience.

The listed categories work for many languages. If your language has different or additional categories that should be checked, add them to the blank lines in your Checklist.

- ☐ In the Checklist, the number of verses is shown for each chapter. Count through to make sure all the verse markers are present in your chapter. Be aware of possible verse bridges (two or more verses written together because they work better that way in the language).
- ☐ If looking at a printout, make sure the number for the chapter is there and has the same spacing as for other chapters.
- ☐ Scan through the chapter text to check for anything else that looks odd (examples: uneven spaces between words, inconsistent sizes for numbers, words spelled incorrectly).
- ☐ Read through the text out loud, checking for typing errors. Mark any you find, writing a quick note about what is wrong.
- ☐ Look specifically at the endings of sentences and make sure each has end punctuation (a period, a question mark, or an exclamation point, as appropriate).
- ☐ Look specifically at the beginnings of sentences to confirm that each one starts with a capital letter.
- ☐ Look specifically for pairs of marks, such as quotation marks, parentheses, and brackets. Does each one have a partner? Does what is inside pairs of quotes sound like it is what someone is saying? Does what is inside pairs of double square brackets** sound like a footnote?
- ☐ Make sure each name is capitalized (for both people and places, if needed).
- ☐ Look through for anything else on your list.

*If the team that is proofreading has BTT Writer available, any errors that are found can be fixed right away. (However, they should not make other changes to the text other than in these categories.) The changed files will need to be re-uploaded.

**In BTT Writer, it is OK to set footnotes in a verse using [[]] (these are called “double square brackets”), as long as they are in pairs. For example, in Matthew 5:44, you might see something like this:

But I say to you, love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you, [[The best ancient copies do not have *Bless those who curse you, do good to those who hate you.*]]